KENJI TANAKA

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Site Reliability Engineer | Payments reliability and cost

SUMMARY

SRE keeping a payments stack reliable and cost-aware. On-call lead for tier-1 services with a bias toward runbooks over heroics.

EXPERIENCE

Site Reliability Engineer - PayWave, Tokyo

2018 - Present

- On-call lead for tier-1 services; maintained 99.95% uptime SLA across 7 quarters.
- Reduced AWS spend 15% via rightsizing, savings plans, and a spot mix on batch.
- Built error-budget policy used by 3 product orgs; frozen features twice when burn was high.
- Introduced game days; mean time to detect for synthetic payment failures dropped to 90s.
- Wrote the incident-command checklist now required for Sev-1 bridges.

Systems Engineer - PacketFarm, Tokyo

2014 - 2018

- Migrated 40 VMs to Kubernetes over 11 months with dual-run and rollback drills.
- Owned Jenkins fleet; cut average pipeline time 28% by caching and runner autoscale.
- Handled weekend on-call for a 12-person platform group.

SELECTED INCIDENTS

- 2024-03: payment auth brownout. Led bridge, shed non-critical webhooks, restored in 41 minutes.
- 2022-11: certificate expiry near-miss. Added 30-day page and inventory job; zero repeats.
- 2021-06: Kafka disk saturation. Added lag SLO and disk forecast; capacity tickets now auto-open.

PROJECTS

pager-lite - internal on-call digest

- Aggregates PagerDuty, Slack, and deploy markers. Used by 60 engineers.

cost-guard - weekly AWS anomaly mail

- Flags 20% day-over-day spend jumps. Caught a runaway EMR cluster twice.

EDUCATION

University of Tokyo - B.S. Information Science

SKILLS

Kubernetes, Terraform, Python, Prometheus, Grafana, incident response, capacity planning, AWS

LANGUAGES

Japanese (native), English (professional working)